



BUSINESS CONCEPT & STRATEGY

Gontobbo

A student-focused, app-based bicycle transportation platform designed to ease urban congestion and deliver affordable daily commuting across Dhaka, Bangladesh.

BUSINESS PLAN • MARKET ANALYSIS • STRATEGY & FINANCIAL PLANNING

ABOUT THE PROJECT

Turning a campus commuting problem into a business plan

Gontobbo began as a venture concept exploring how a low-cost, app-enabled bicycle network could solve a daily pain point for university students: getting around a congested city affordably and reliably. The project was developed end-to-end as a full business plan — from market and industry research through to strategy, operations, and financial planning.



MY ROLE

Business Plan & Strategy Lead

- Industry & PEST analysis
 - Go-to-market & marketing strategy
 - Financial plan & revenue model
 - Risk assessment
- Group plan developed for an entrepreneurship course; presented here to showcase individual contribution to strategy and financial planning.*

Getting around the city is slow, costly, and unreliable



Chronic congestion

Dhaka's traffic is among the world's most severe, turning short trips into long, unpredictable ones.



Cost pressure

Ride-hailing and private transport are too expensive for regular use on a student budget.



Coverage gaps

Major transport networks don't reliably reach the short, everyday routes students rely on.

THE SOLUTION

Gontobbo: on-demand bicycles, booked from an app

Gontobbo is a bicycle transportation service operated through an app and website, giving students a fast way to book a bike for short, everyday trips — built to eventually connect with the city's wider transport network.



App & web booking



Low-cost, student-first pricing



Designated pickup & parking hubs



Built to plug into major transport



Cost-effective transport

for the routes that matter most to students

Affordable

Reliable

Sustainable

A growing need, and room to lead it



Industry Demand

- Rising student population and daily commuting needs around university corridors in Dhaka.
- Growing preference for low-cost, flexible transport as fuel and ride-hailing prices climb.
- Increasing city-wide focus on reducing congestion and promoting non-motorized transport.



Competitive Landscape

- Ride-hailing apps compete on convenience but not on price for short trips.
- Traditional rickshaws remain the closest substitute, but lack app-based booking.
- No dominant player currently owns the app-based bicycle-transport niche in the market.

PEST Analysis



Political

City policy increasingly favors reduced congestion and non-motorized transport options.



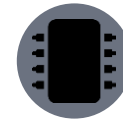
Economic

Rising cost of fuel and ride-hailing strengthens the case for an affordable alternative.



Social

Growing student population and health-consciousness support bicycle adoption.



Technological

Widespread smartphone use makes app-based booking and tracking practical to deploy.

How the venture runs day to day



Venture setup

Positioned as a dedicated bicycle-transport service with a clear mission to reduce urban congestion for students.



Location strategy

Operating base and pickup hubs placed near university corridors for maximum daily reach.



Equipment & supply

Fleet and office equipment scoped to support a phased, make-to-order rollout.

OPERATIONS FLOW



1. Book via app

Student requests a bike through the Gontobbo app or website.



2. Make-to-order dispatch

Nearest available bike is assigned from the supply chain in real time.



3. Pickup at a hub

Rider collects the bike from one of four designated parking lots.



4. Return & maintenance

Bike is returned, inspected, and cycled back into the fleet.

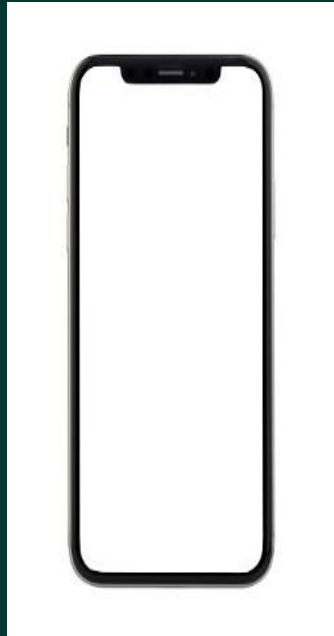
Four parking hubs, one connected route

Manufacturing process: make to order • Inventory: manual supply chain

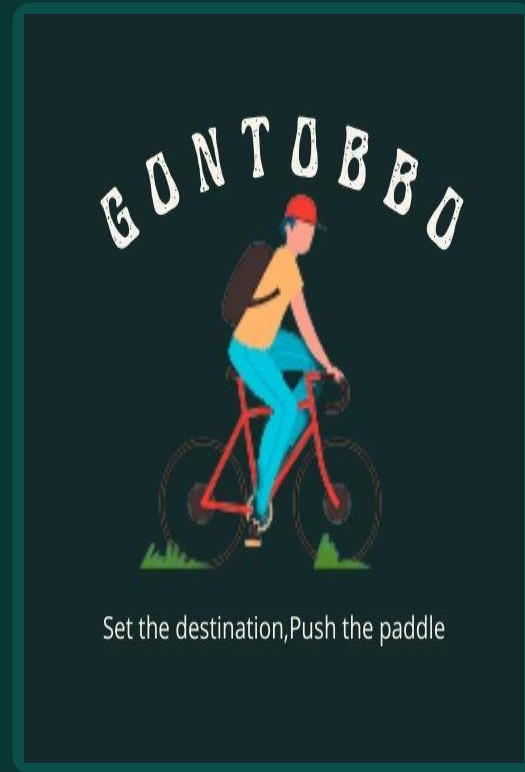


Hubs positioned along a single corridor connecting a residential area, a market, the permanent campus, and student housing — covering the routes students travel most.

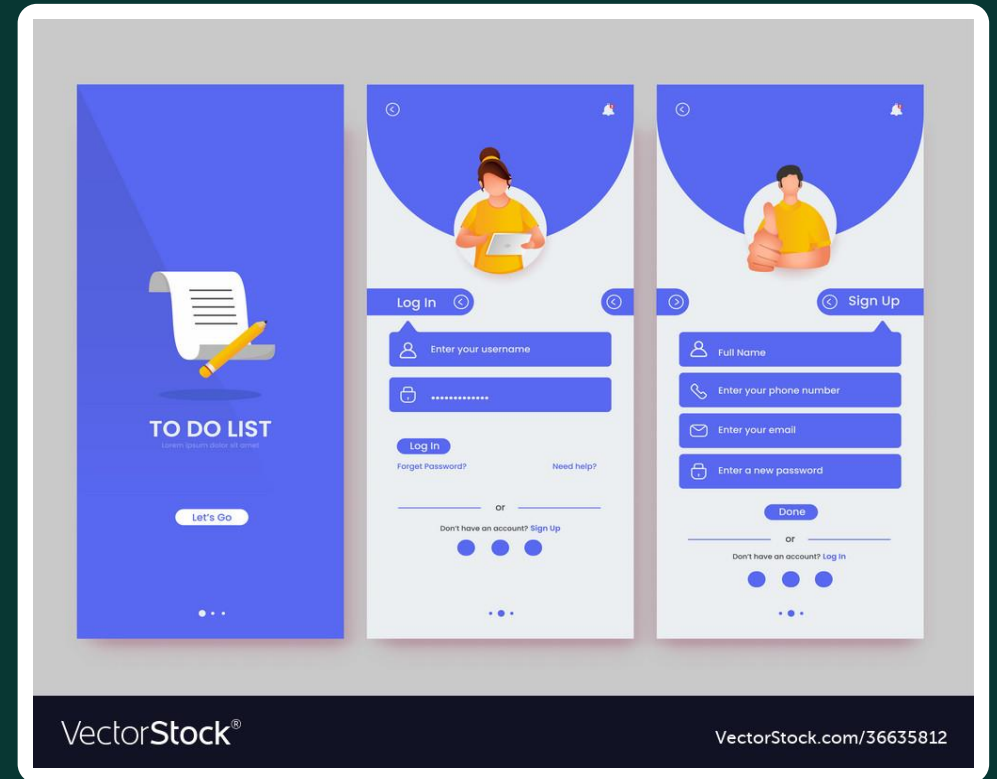
Registration Process



1. Open the app



2. Gontobbo welcome screen



3. Log in or create an account

Marketing strategy

Gontobbo's marketing strategy centers on prime, high-footfall locations near campus — making the service part of students' daily routine and the service they trust for quick, dependable, low-cost trips.



Prime location advantage

Hubs placed where students already move, minimizing friction to first use.



Daily-habit positioning

Framed as part of the daily commute, not a one-off service.



Trust through reliability

Consistent, quick turnaround builds dependence for repeat, everyday use.



“Part of their daily experience”

The positioning goal: a shop — and a service —
students can depend on.

Initial investment & monthly operating cost



Initial Investment

Total: 682,000 BDT

Item	Calculation	Amount (BDT)
Bicycle purchase	60 × 8,000	480,000
Equipment	—	8,000
Server & app cost	—	50,000
GPS tracker	—	24,000
Bicycle accessories	—	120,000
Total		682,000



Monthly Operating Cost

Total: 55,000 BDT / month

Item	Amount (BDT)
Parking / garage rent	10,000
Utility cost	6,000
Repair & Maintenance	5,000 each
Counter manager	2,500
Employee salary (team)	40,000
Provisions	5,000
Miscellaneous Expense	2,000
Total	55,000

Figures reflect the original venture plan's cost assumptions (officer salaries shown individually in the model; grouped above for readability).

Revenue & profit projection

60

Bicycles in fleet

5

Avg. rides / bike / day

112,500

Monthly revenue (BDT)

64,500

Monthly profit (BDT)

HOW THE NUMBERS WORK

1

Avg. profit per bicycle per day: 5 rides $\times$ 15 BDT = 75 BDT

2

Fleet profit per day: 75 BDT $\times$ 60 bicycles = 4,500 BDT

3

Monthly revenue: 4,500 BDT $\times$ 25 operating days = 112,500 BDT

4

Monthly profit expectation: 64,500 BDT (after costs, situation-dependent)

GROWTH OUTLOOK

774,000 BDT

projected profit / year

2,322,000 BDT

projected profit / 3 years, if routes expand
across Dhaka as planned

Note: figures are drawn directly from the original venture model's own assumptions and are illustrative, not audited projections.

What could slow Gontobbo down — and how to manage it



Political influence

Local regulation or permitting changes could affect operations.

MITIGATION

Engage early with city stakeholders and stay policy-compliant.



E-bike competition

Emerging electric-bike alternatives could shift rider preference.

MITIGATION

Differentiate on price and campus-first convenience.



Unethical practices

Risk of misuse, fraud, or unsafe conduct within the network.

MITIGATION

Clear registration, accountability, and usage policies.

CONCLUSION

A small vehicle for a big problem



Eases traffic congestion

Every trip shifted to a bicycle is one less vehicle competing for road space in Dhaka.



Supports healthier living

Regular cycling gives students an active, low-cost alternative to sedentary commuting.



A credible path forward

Gontobbo offers a realistic, scalable option to help address the city's transport bottleneck.

Thank you